AI in the Sports Analytics Industry

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Why This Topic Matters to Me

- Lifelong sports fan intrigued by the unpredictability of competition
- Drawn to strategy heavy sports such as motorsport, football, and soccer
- Academic experience in statistics and decision analysis
- Project allowed to connect personal interests to AI and real world opportunity

Industry Snapshot

$4.8 Billion+
Global Market Size (2024)

Accounting for 40% of total market size

20% CAGR
Projected U.S. Growth Rate

Key Players:

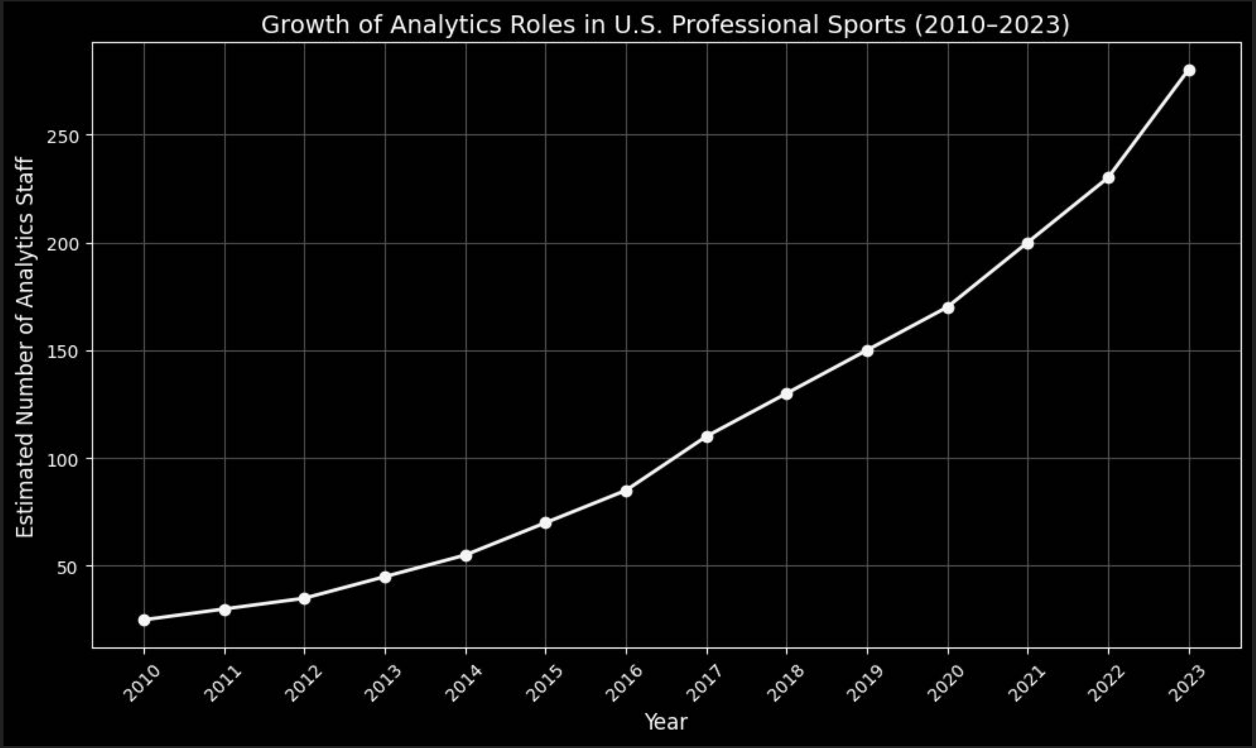
STATS PERFORM

CATAPULT

Genius SPORTS

sportradar

Employment Opportunity Growth



- Number of data analysts and statisticians employed by professional sports organizations has grown significantly
- Analytics roles in spectator sports rising from <30 in 2010 to over 280 in 2023 (Data averaging number of analytics staff per professional organization)

How AI is Changing the Game

Then: A Support Function

Analytics was primarily used for post-game video breakdowns or basic scouting reports

Now: A Strategic Core

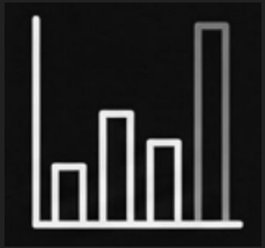
AI-driven platforms are central to:

- **Labor and staffing:** Creating new roles that require data and AI fluency
- **Competition:** Market power is now tied to proprietary data and platforms (e.g. Genius Sports, Sportradar)
- **Productivity:** Automating thousands of hours of manual work

Three Dimensions of AI's Impact

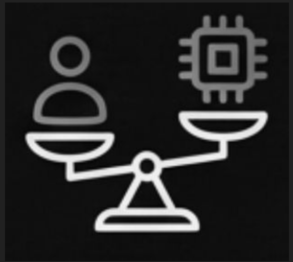
New Capabilities

- Real time player tracking and performance management
- Predictive models for scouting, player valuation, and injury prevention
- Enhanced fan engagement through betting and fantasy



New Economics

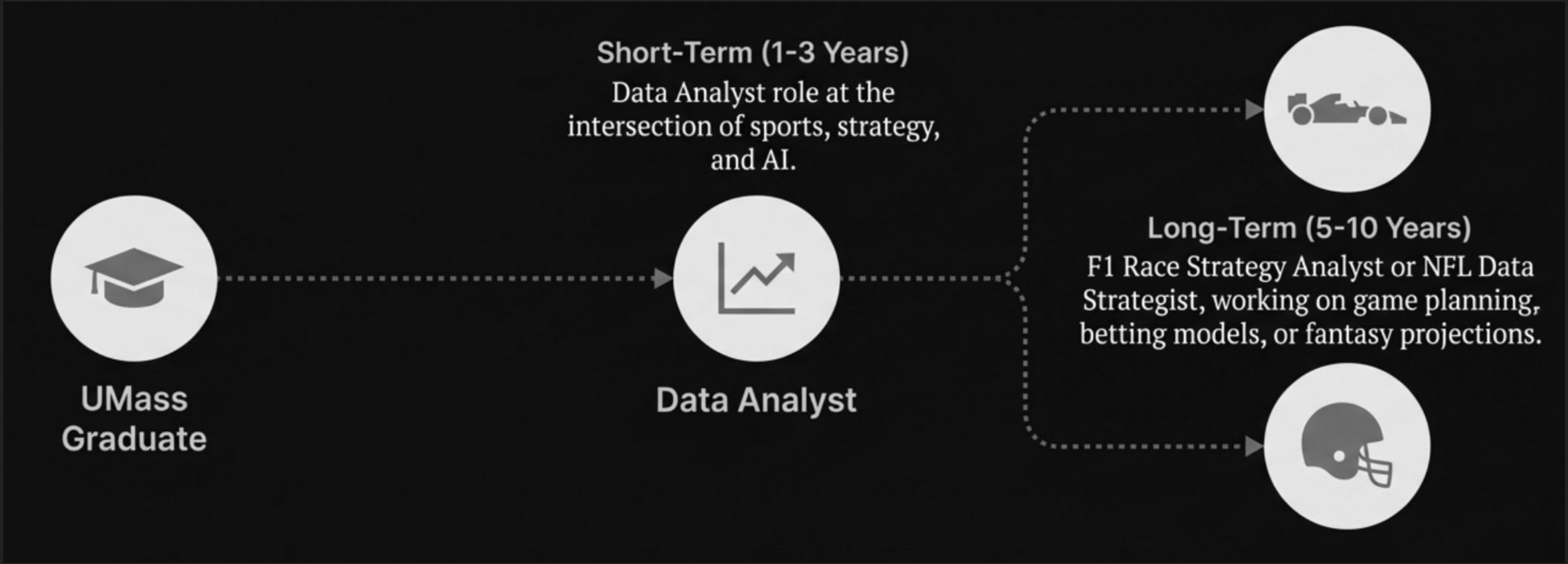
- Shifts production toward software and data infrastructure
- Creates data monopolies and potential for rent-extraction
- Creates new business models and attracts interdisciplinary talent



New Challenges

- Displacement risks for non-technical staff
- Algorithmic bias in player evaluation models
- Player privacy concerns from biometric data collection

My Path to this Industry



I want to apply my strengths in economic reasoning, forecasting, and statistical analysis to solve complex problems tied to human performance

My 6-12 Month Upskilling Plan

Technical Foundations

Build fluency in Python and advanced Excel through my accelerated master's in business analytics

Portfolio Projects

Develop independent projects using real sports data (e.g., forecasting models, fantasy football simulations)

Communication Skills

Sharpen my ability to communicate technical information to non-specialist decision makers (coaches, managers)

Teamwork and Leadership

Continue building collaborative skills through group projects and hands-on experiences

Reflection

Before

My View:

- Saw AI mostly as a shortcut or tool used unethically to cut corners

My Approach

- I assumed that it replaced the need to learn fundamentals

After

My View

- I see AI as a powerful collaborator and assistant rather than a replacement

My Approach

- I now focus on problem framing, precise communication, and critical validation of AI outputs

This class gave me the confidence and knowledge to see AI as not as a replacement for my skills, but a powerful tool to build upon them